

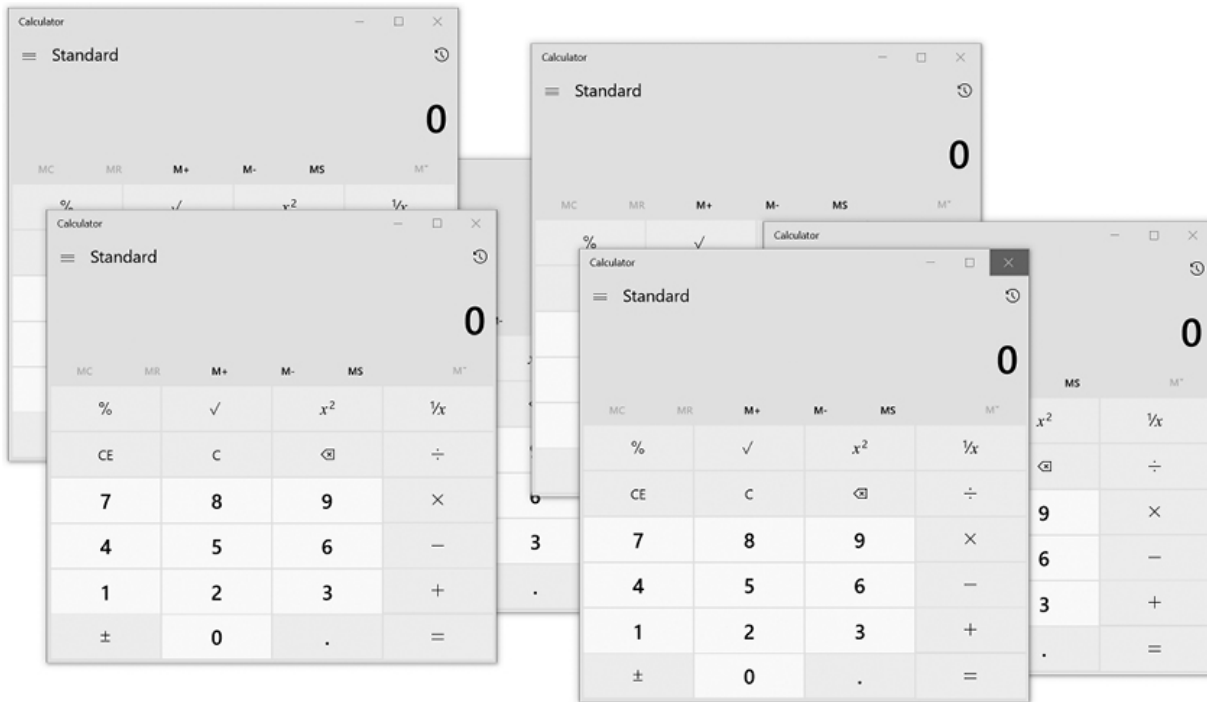


Figure 2-3: One calculator program running multiple times as multiple, separate processes

Processes remain separate from each other, even when running the same program. For example, if you ran several instances of a Python program at the same time, each process might have separate variable values. Every process, even processes running the same program, has its own cwd and environment variable settings. Generally speaking, a command line will run only one process at a time (although you can have multiple command lines open simultaneously).

Each operating system has a way of viewing a list of running processes. On Windows, you can press CTRL-SHIFT-ESC to bring up the Task Manager application. On macOS, you can run Applications►Utilities►Activity Monitor. On Ubuntu Linux, you can press CTRL-ALT-DEL to open an application also called the Task Manager. These task managers can force a running process to terminate if it's unresponsive.

The Command Line